Our key independent variable quantifies the degree of populism influencing each IO annually. Using IO membership data from Pevehouse, Nordstrom, and Warnke (2004), we calculate the number of member states led by populist executives, as identified by Funke, Schularick, and Trebesch (2023). In addition, we incorporate several controls based on Ecker-Ehrhardt's prior analyses. These include transnational access, or the extent to which civil society and activists direct demands at an IO; protests, measured as a binary indicator of whether an organization faced an anti-IO protest in a given year; and scandals, measured as a binary indicator capturing whether an IO experienced a significant scandal. We also control for member-state democraticness using average Polity2 democracy scores of member states, local intervention using the extent to which IOs engage in operations on the ground in target states, budget size using an IO's minimum budget allocation, and issue areas using dummies capturing sectoral contexts like security or development. The unit of analysis is the IO-year, and we follow Ecker-Ehrhardt (2018b) by employing a negative binomial model with year-fixed effects as our main specification.

Table 7.5 presents our regression results, which strongly support the notion that populism drives IOs to centralize their communication strategies. In the bivariate analysis (column 1), we observe a statistically significant and positive relationship between the number of populist-led member states and the centralization index. Substantively, the rise of populism in one additional member state correlates with approximately a 10 percent increase in the centralization of an IO's communication procedures. These results remain robust when including Ecker-Ehrhardt's key independent variables (column 2) and additional controls (column 3). Even when testing alternative specifications—such as including all covariates simultaneously or excluding specific variables—our findings remain consistent.

TABLE 7.5. Populism and centralization of communication

	Centralization		
	Model 1	**Model 2**	**Model 3**

Note: Robust standard errors are clustered at the country-level. Data for the DV and control variables come from Ecker-Ehrhardt (2018).
***p <.01; **p <.05; *p <.1